Rian Touchent-Saad

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AI Researcher | LLM Training & Evaluation | Medical AI

Education

Inria Paris - Sorbonne Université — Paris, France
Ph.D. in Artificial Intelligence - ALMAnaCH Team — *2023 – October 2026*

- **Thesis**: Improving Clinical Information Extraction with Public-Data Pretraining
- **Advisors**: Laurent Romary and Éric de la Clergerie
- Trained 7B decoder (128 MI250X, 8.7k GPU-hours) and encoder matching English clinical SOTA with **2.5x fewer tokens**, using neural data filters
- Core contributor to Gaperon (1.5B-24B open LLMs): designed synthetic quality annotations (500k docs) and benchmark contamination study (BIaHs)

CentraleSupélec - Université Paris-Saclay — Gif-sur-Yvette, France
MSc in Artificial Intelligence — *2021 – 2022*

ECE Paris School of Engineering — Paris, France
Master's in Computer Science (Diplôme d'Ingénieur) — *2017 – 2022*

Publications

Published as Rian Touchent. 6 first-author papers, 111 citations, 25k+ monthly model downloads. Full list: Google Scholar

Don't Want Your LLM to Recommend Nuclear Strike? Try Asking It in Japanese — *TrustNLP @ ACL 2026*

- R. Touchent
- Wargame evaluation of 9 frontier models across languages (3,600+ runs): the same model launches a nuclear strike in English and refuses in Japanese
- Open-source zero-dependency harness (wargame-evals); re-evaluates each newly released frontier model; results published as an interactive blog post

TABIB: Towards a French Adversarial Benchmark for Biomedical LLMs — *EvalLLM 2026 (in French)*

- R. Touchent, É. de la Clergerie
- Behavioral benchmark testing French biomedical LLMs under semantics-preserving adversarial perturbations (drug interactions, patient pressure, demographic bias)

Biomed-Enriched: A Biomedical Dataset Enriched with LLMs for Pretraining and Extracting Rare and Hidden Content — *ACL 2026*

- R. Touchent, N. Godey, É. de la Clergerie
- Encoder matches English clinical SOTA (BioClinical-ModernBERT) with 2.5x fewer tokens using only public data. 7B decoder reaches baseline with 3x fewer tokens

Gaperon: A Peppered English-French Generative Language Model Suite — *ACL 2026*

- N. Godey, W. Antoun, R. Touchent, et al.
- Contributions: data curation, synthetic quality annotations, BIaHs study (showed quality filters amplify benchmark leakage 20x)

CamemBERT-bio: Leveraging Continual Pre-training for Cost-Effective Models on French Biomedical Data — *LREC-COLING 2024*

- R. Touchent, L. Romary, É. de la Clergerie
- Collected 413M-word French biomedical corpus from diverse sources
- Trained SOTA French biomedical encoder (100k+ downloads) with 32x less compute than from-scratch

A Causal Language Modeling Detour Improves Encoder Continued Pretraining — *arXiv 2026*

- R. Touchent, É. de la Clergerie
- Showed a causal language modeling phase before MLM decay improves domain-adaptive continued pretraining of biomedical encoders

OntoBook: Ontology-Grounded Synthetic Textbooks for Medical Encoder Pretraining *KG-LLM @ LREC 2026*

- R. Touchent, É. de la Clergerie
- Generated synthetic medical textbooks from clinical ontologies (ICD-10, CCAM, ATC) as a pretraining signal for biomedical encoders

Research Experience

AI Researcher October 2026 – Present
Inria Paris - ALMAnaCH Team *Paris, France*

- Training and evaluation of LLMs for medicine, continuing the PhD work

R&D Consultant - NLP/NER Spring 2025
ViaDialog (Freelance) *Paris, France*

- Built French text anonymization system using NER for customer data
- Designed LLM annotation pipeline (vLLM + constrained decoding) to generate synthetic training data; distilled to production NER model (F1 0.3 → 0.82)

Founding AI Engineer June 2023 – June 2024
Praxysanté – Healthcare AI startup *Paris, France*

- Deployed open-source LLMs (7B-70B) for healthcare applications with quantization (GPTQ, AWQ) on high-end GPUs
- Built production inference pipeline with vLLM and FastAPI

Pre-doctoral Researcher - Biomedical NLP June 2022 – November 2022
Inria Paris - ALMAnaCH Team *Paris, France*

- Built CamemBERT-bio (see Publications). Work led to PhD position

Teaching Experience

Lecturer - Advanced NLP Fall 2025
EPITA School of Engineering *Paris, France*

- Taught Advanced NLP course (ANLP) to final-year engineering students
- Topics: Domain-specific NLP, Multilingual NLP, Advanced NLP Tasks

Teaching Assistant - Computer Science 2023 – 2024
CentraleSupélec *Gif-sur-Yvette, France*

- Taught introductory CS to first-year engineering students (Python, Git, SQL)

Technical Skills

Training: LLM Pretraining, Continued Pretraining, Fine-tuning, Domain Adaptation, Data Curation, Synthetic Data
Evaluation & Safety: Benchmark Design, Behavioral Evaluation, Adversarial Robustness, Red-Teaming, LLM-as-judge, Benchmark Contamination Analysis
Domains: Medical AI, Clinical Information Extraction, NER, Multilingual (French/English)
Deep Learning: PyTorch, Hugging Face, vLLM, DeepSpeed, FSDP, FlashAttention
Data Processing: Datatrove, Multinode CPU/GPU pipelines, Corpus preprocessing
Infrastructure: Distributed Training, AMD MI250x, NVIDIA H100/A100, Slurm
Programming: Python, Bash, SQL
Tools: Git, Weights & Biases, Docker, Linux, LaTeX

Selected Honors

PAISS 2021 - Paris AI Summer School (lectures by Y. LeCun, C. Schmid, and others)
Merit Scholarship (2019) - Ranked 1st/379 at ECE Paris
Prologin Semi-finalist (2018) - French National Computer Science Contest